

LISTENING

#38

1 – Listen to a man asking a woman for money and discussing his financial situation. Pay attention to his main expenses, the reasons he is in debt, and the changes the woman recommends.

Budget Planner

1 - Why is the man asking the woman for money?

- a) He needs to pay his rent immediately.
- b) He does not have enough money until payday.
- c) He wants to pay back another friend.

2 - Why is the woman hesitant to lend him more money?

3 - What is causing the man's financial problems?

4 – What does the man jokingly say he does when running out of money?

- a) He uses money from his savings account.
- b) He asks the woman to lend him some.
- c) He works additional hours at his job.

5 - How much does he pay in rent for his studio apartment?

6 - Why does the man spend around \$600 a month on food?

7 - Which expenses does the man include in his entertainment spending?

8 - What changes does the woman recommend that he make?

9 - Why does the woman say that the man now owes her \$50?

Full Name _____

READING COMPREHENSION

More Money, More Problems

After Lucas received a promotion, his monthly salary increased, and he decided it was time to improve his lifestyle. He moved into a more expensive apartment, bought a newer phone, and began eating at restaurants several times a week. At first, he believed he could afford everything without difficulty.

The problems started when he bought furniture using his credit card. The store offered twelve monthly payments, so each payment seemed manageable. Soon afterward, Lucas used the same card to pay for a vacation and car repairs. He focused on the monthly payments instead of the total amount he owed.

A few months later, Lucas noticed that most of his salary disappeared soon after payday. He was paying rent, credit card bills, car expenses, subscriptions, and restaurant costs. When an unexpected dental bill arrived, he did not have enough money in his account and had to borrow from his brother.

His brother agreed to help but suggested that Lucas write down all his expenses. Lucas was surprised to discover that he was paying for three streaming services, a gym membership he rarely used, and frequent food deliveries. Small purchases had been adding up without him noticing.

Lucas created a budget and separated his expenses into needs and wants. He canceled two subscriptions, started taking lunch to work, and limited restaurant meals to twice a month. He also sold some furniture he no longer needed and used the money to reduce his credit card balance.

The changes were frustrating at first because Lucas felt that he was giving up many things he enjoyed. However, after four months, he no longer needed to borrow money, and his debt had decreased considerably. He realized that earning more money had not solved his financial problems. Learning to control his spending had made the real difference.

Comprehension Questions

1 - Why did Lucas begin spending more money after his promotion?

2 - Why did his credit card purchases initially seem affordable?

3 - What changes did Lucas make after creating a budget?

4 - Do you think people usually spend more when their income increases? Why or why not?

5 - Which unnecessary monthly expenses would be easiest for you to reduce?
